



MONTHLY UPDATE

Ghana: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-05 • 80 systems and instruments tracked, 18 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-05 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

Two regulatory clocks started in July. The identity regulator gave institutions [until 2 November 2026](#) to stop taking card photocopies and integrate with biometric verification, and the telecommunications regulator [amended its 5G spectrum offer in seven places](#) and moved the submission deadline to 27 August. Parliament approved a multi-year commitment for three revenue platforms on 28 July with no disclosed cost. On 3 August the central bank named twenty unlicensed lending applications.

Infrastructure

The regulator's [consolidated response of 31 July](#) answered sixty written queries from four prospective applicants, formally amended the request for applications in seven places, and shifted every subsequent date by 21 days, with licence fees now due 17 November. It refused any extension to the 70% population coverage obligation of 6 March 2027 while confirming that obligation is band- and technology-neutral and can be met in substantial part from existing deployment. It also rewrote the dominant operator's rural schedule from licence-relative years into fixed dates of December 2029, 2032 and 2035, expressly so that buying spectrum would not accelerate an equivalent existing commitment. And it recharacterised the 40% premium on that operator's reserve prices in writing as a price for attributable value rather than a sanction or a market-power remedy, declining to publish its valuation model during a live assignment.

The country's largest data-centre campus by committed capacity entered the record on 28 July at [30 MW designed for expansion to 150 MW](#), through a regional trade round-up with no Ghanaian primary behind it. A community-media cyber capability project launched on 3 August, certifying community-radio journalists into a standing press corps.

Digital public infrastructure

The identity regulator publicised amendment regulations on 16 July that had come into force on 9 June, and the interior minister then set the enforcement date: banks, telecoms operators, hospitals, schools, insurers and agencies have [a three-month transition from 27 July to 2 November 2026](#) to install readers and integrate with the

verification service, on a sanctions ladder running to suspension of access and licence withdrawal. Verification tied to SIM registration is explicitly excluded, with no timetable announced. The first paid round-the-clock identity centre opened on 1 August with all services attracting approved charges and no fee schedule published.

Central bank data for June 2026 put mobile money at [954 million transactions worth GH¢492.9bn](#), against GH¢323.2bn a year earlier, on 84.6 million registered wallets of which 26.4 million were active; interoperable transfers were GH¢6.2bn, about 1.3% of value.

Enforcement of the digital-credit regime opened. A notice of 20 July recorded the 30 June licensing deadline as elapsed, and a notice of [3 August named twenty unlicensed lending applications](#), cautioning banks and payment providers against processing for them and framing the harm first as a violation of customer data privacy. The promised register of licensed providers remains unpublished.

The finance ministry reported to Parliament that the customs valuation system had [analysed about 366,000 declarations to 17 July](#), 24% triggering more than one risk indicator, with collections up 17.5% against a 6.3% rise in declared value. A second public sector reform strategy was validated on 30 July on seven pillars, 27 programmes and 135 activities.

Governance and regulation

Parliament [approved a multi-year expenditure commitment on 28 July](#) for three revenue platforms — a fiscal device policy, a cross-border electronic-commerce tax system going live in September 2026, and a domestic collection platform still to be procured — with published benefit projections and no disclosed total cost, contract duration or termination terms. The opposition [rejected all three](#), alleging the cross-border operator could take up to 3% of collections, about GH¢690m a year, and that the unit cost of 40,000 fiscal devices and who ultimately pays for them were never disclosed.

The ministry took industry comment on 27 July on the [draft digital economy and innovation development fund bill](#), which would convert the universal-access fund into a wider innovation and skills fund; the levy rate, governance structure and the fate of the rural-access earmark are all unestablished, and the draft is not published. Speaking at an artificial-intelligence summit on 29 July, the ministry named a data harmonisation Act and a proposed data exchange Act as the enabling layer under a ten-year implementation plan — the first mention on file of an exchange statute distinct from harmonisation, and neither has a published draft.

The regulator's own enforcement record did not change. The action framed as a data-privacy violation in the month was taken by the central bank.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

The government [announced a ten-year artificial-intelligence implementation plan on 29 July](#) with measurable annual milestones, built with United Nations partners, and reaffirmed the US\$250m compute centre approved in April. UNESCO's Accra head replied from the same platform that strategies without funding and execution remain shell documents. Sixteen weeks after Cabinet approval, the compute centre has no site, contractor or procurement notice.

Applications opened on 1 July for an applied artificial-intelligence lab in Accra, closing 31 August with no cohort size or Ghana-specific spend disclosed. On 27 July a company filed a writ claiming authorship of the 2007 design of the dominant mobile-money platform; the operator answered on 31 July that the claims are without merit and it will contest fully.

Inclusion, capacity and finance

Training capacity was the month's activity. A youth agency [signed for 2,000 vendor-certified microdegree places on 14 July](#) — Ghana taking 2,000 of the 3,000 allocated to the whole continent — fully government-funded, with 600 paid internships and a five-region pilot, and no programme cost disclosed. A university became the first tertiary institution to embed the national coders programme permanently in its curriculum on 29 July, receiving a further 2,000 laptops the next day. The education council completed a revised basic-education curriculum adding coding, artificial intelligence and technical subjects, announced on 20 July and not yet adopted.

The mid-year fiscal review of 23 July recorded GH¢485m paid to cash-grant beneficiaries in the first half of 2026 and named no allocation at all to the communications ministry, the access fund, the coders programme or the artificial-intelligence strategy.

At a policy dialogue on 29 July the regulator said an existing hotspot authorisation [could found a dedicated community-network regime](#), with no timetable, consultation or draft announced; a civil-society policy lead placed four other African states ahead of Ghana on enabling frameworks.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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